<!-- Extracted from https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/doc/help/editinginatf/quickreference/index.html on 2026-10-16 by a stdlib HTML->Markdown converter; see raw .html for the original. -->

ATF Quick Reference

A quick reference sheet for the ATF format.

Structure Conventions

See the Structure Tutorial for more details.

| & | Text/catalogue number designator

| @<type> | @composite (for composite texts)

| @<object> | Object = @tablet, @envelope, @prism, @object <object-type>

| @<surface> | Surface = @obverse, @reverse, @surface, @edge, @left, @right, @top, @bottom, @face [a..z]

| @seal <n> | for transliteration of seal impressions on objects; n=number

| @column | column

| <number>. | line of text

| <number>.<subcases>. | line of text with subdivision into cases

| $ <qualification> <extent> <scope> <state> | non-text, such as breakage, blank lines, etc.

qualification = at least, at most, about

number = NUMBER, RANGE, n, several, some, start of, beginning of, middle of, end of, rest of

scope = OBJECT, SURFACE, case(s), column(s), line(s), surface

state = blank, broken, damaged, effaced, illegible, missing, traces

| $ <multiple> ruling | horizontal ruling(s) in the text

multiple = single, double, triple

| $ (image N = <text>) | location of inline image, such as a seal impression or a diagram

| # | comment line

| =: | multiplexing comment line giving original order of interpreted/reordered signs in preceding line of transliteration.

| <whitespace> | continues previous line (modern convenience, not ancient line break)

Inline ASCII Conventions

See the ATF Inline Tutorial for more details.

| [A-ZṢŠṬ][a-zṣšṭ][₀-₉] | grapheme name

| <hyphen> | joiner for graphemes of single word

| <space> | word separator

| ! | flags correction of sign

| ? | flags uncertainty of identification or reading

| * | flags collation

| # | flags damage to sign

| [...] | encloses material broken away from object

| [(...)] | encloses material perhaps broken away from object

| value(SIGN) | explanatory name or variant form after value

| value!(SIGN) | actual signs on object given after corrected version

| <...> | accidental omission supplied by editor

| <(...)> | intentional omission supplied by editor

| MIN<(...)> | surrogate text supplied by editor

| <<...>> | material removed by editor

| {...} | determinative delimiters (written in normal script)

| {{...}} | gloss delimiters

| $ | following sign is not a logogram

| x | unclear sign

| X | clear sign not yet identified

| |...| | compound grapheme delimiters

| [.x%&+()] | compound grapheme operators (see QR.3 below)

| [āēīū], [âêîû] | long vowels in normalized Akkadian

| %[sahrux] | language shift

| %e,%u,%g,%n | register/writing system shift

Compound Grapheme Conventions

See the ATF Inline Tutorial for full documentation of these conventions.

| . | juxtaposed signs, e.g., DU.DU

| × | following sign(s) written over/within preceding sign, e.g., GA_2×AN

| & | signs are written one above the other, e.g., DU&DU

as opposed to standard DU

| + | signs are ligatured, e.g., |LAGAB+LAGAB|($nigin_2$)

| (...) | grouping of signs, e.g., GA_2×(ME.EN)

| @g | gunu, e.g., DU@g

as opposed to standard DU

| @t | tenu, e.g., GAN_2@t

| @v | variant, e.g., 4(ban_2)@v

as opposed to the standard 4(ban_2)

18 Dec 2019 osc at oracc dot org

Steve Tinney & Eleanor Robson

Steve Tinney & Eleanor Robson, 'ATF Quick Reference', *Oracc: The Open Richly Annotated Cuneiform Corpus*, Oracc, 2019
[http://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/doc/help/editinginatf/quickreference/]

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